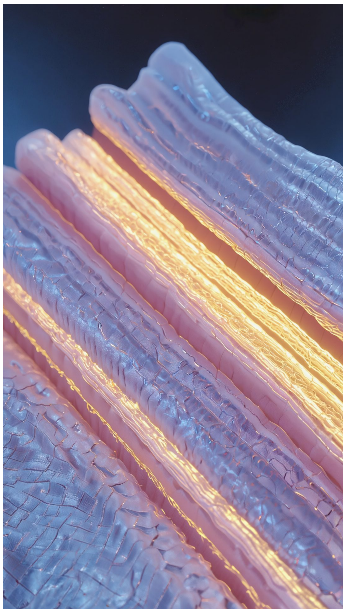
Myofascial Recovery Protocol

Peak Performance Wellness · v1 · DRAFT for GATE-2 review



Deep-fascia cross-section — the myofascial layers and glide planes this protocol works (PPW scientific render).

Wellness, not medical care. This protocol shares wellness guidance and education based on Peak Performance Wellness's evidence base. It is **not** medical diagnosis, treatment, or advice, and it does not diagnose conditions or replace a qualified healthcare professional. For anything medical, or anything that worries you, please see a clinician. If it's an emergency, contact your local emergency services.

What this is

A wellness recovery routine built around manual myofascial work and post-exercise recovery. It's education and general guidance from Peak Performance Wellness — a way to feel and move better after hard training or a long day. It is not a medical treatment for any condition.

The evidence behind it

Every claim below is anchored to the PPW science knowledge base (peer-reviewed sources). Where the evidence is limited we say so plainly — no cure claims.

Myofascial release significantly improves pain and physical function in people with chronic low-back pain.

*Honest read: the benefit is real but modest. It does **not** reliably improve quality of life, balance, pain-pressure threshold or trunk mobility, and the underlying trials were small and of low–moderate quality. Not a cure.*

Source — Wu Z et al. Myofascial Release for Chronic Low Back Pain: systematic review & meta-analysis of 8 RCTs (n=375). Front Med 2021. PMID:34395477 · doi:10.3389/fmed.2021.697986 [KB-0002]

Hyaluronan is the molecule that lets fascial layers glide over each other; when it "densifies" and becomes more viscous, the layers glide less — a described mechanism of myofascial pain that manual work and movement aim to reverse.

Honest read: this is a well-described ***mechanism*** *(Stecco/Padua school), not a proven clinical cure pathway. Manual work targets this mechanism — it does not, on its own, "fix" pain.*

Source — Fede C et al. Quantification of hyaluronan in human fasciae. J Anat 2018. PMID:30040133 · doi:10.1111/joa.12866

Source — Pratt RL. Hyaluronan and the Fascial Frontier. Int J Mol Sci 2021. PMID:34202183 · doi:10.3390/ijms22136845 [KB-0005]

Massage after strenuous exercise significantly reduces delayed-onset muscle soreness (at 24, 48 and 72 hours) and lowers creatine kinase, a blood marker of muscle damage, with small improvements in muscle force.

Honest read: this is post-exercise massage for soreness — ***not*** *a deep-fascia clinical-outcome study. It supports recovery; it does not treat any chronic condition.*

Source — Davis HL et al. Massage Alleviates Delayed Onset Muscle Soreness: systematic review & meta-analysis (11 studies, 504 participants). Front Physiol 2017. PMID:29021762 [KB-0010]

The routine

- After hard training or a long day, apply slow, sustained myofascial work to the muscles you worked — by hand, with a therapist, or self-release. This is what eases post-exercise soreness [KB-0010] and targets fascial glide [KB-0005].
- Keep moving gently between sessions — light, pain-free movement rather than complete rest.
- For ongoing low-back discomfort, myofascial release is a reasonable wellness option to ease pain and improve day-to-day function [KB-0002] — alongside, not instead of, professional care.
- Mind the recovery cadence: soreness usually peaks around 24–72 hours, so space your hardest sessions and let it settle.
- If pain is severe, persistent, or comes with red-flag symptoms (numbness, weakness, loss of bladder/bowel control), stop and see a qualified clinician.

Honesty caveat. *Evidence strongest for pain and physical function; does not reliably improve quality of life, balance, or mobility. Not a cure claim.*

Evidence anchors

KB-0002 — Wu Z et al. Myofascial Release for Chronic Low Back Pain: a Systematic Review and Meta-Analysis. Front Med (Lausanne) 2021. PMID:34395477 · doi:10.3389/fmed.2021.697986 — evidence tier: meta-analysis.

KB-0005 — Fede C et al. Quantification of hyaluronan in human fasciae. J Anat 2018. PMID:30040133 · doi:10.1111/joa.12866; Pratt RL. Hyaluronan and the Fascial Frontier. Int J Mol Sci 2021. PMID:34202183 · doi:10.3390/ijms22136845 — evidence tier: review.

KB-0010 — Davis HL et al. Massage Alleviates Delayed Onset Muscle Soreness after Strenuous Exercise: a Systematic Review and Meta-Analysis. Front Physiol 2017. PMID:29021762 — evidence tier: meta-analysis.

Anchored against the PPW science KB (08-Memory/ppw-science-kb). All three claims are status: anchored.